

Minutes of Meeting between DFR Staff, Contractors and M/S Grid – Goal - Associates

In Attendance

DFR Staff

1. George Addison – Regional Manager (Chairman)
2. Eric Agbley – Contract Manager
3. Kwasi Owusu Adu-Gyamfi – Operations Manager (IV) (Recorder)
4. Walter Atsu – Lab, DFR

M/S Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates (IDA Consultants)

1. Joe Lamptey – Team Leader
2. C.K Vasco – Civil Engineer
3. Emmanuel Okang Klu – Civil Engineer
4. Mustapha Gamel – Technician Engineer
5. Edward M. Amegashie - Technician Engineer
6. Dumedah K. Courage - Technician Engineer
7. Attipoe B. John – Technician Engineer

Contractors

1. Zukaria Suhunun - Supervisor (M/S Asmaraite Enterprise)
2. Kwaku Amoako Boateng – Managing Director (M/S Asti Agencies Limited)
3. Emmanuel Badu Sackey – Project Engineer (M/S Samwilco Enterprise)
4. Samuel Yankson – Foreman (M/S Ceco Engineering Limited)

Absent

1. M/S J.O Awuah and Brothers Limited
2. M/S Awally Complex Limited

Introduction

The meeting started at 10:40 AM with a prayer by Mr. Mustapha Gamel of Grid – Goal – Besuma Associates. Mr. Kwasi Owusu Adu-Gyamfi, Operations Manager IV of DFR introduced the Chairman of the meeting in the person of Mr. George Addison, Regional Manager, DFR. The Chairman welcomed all members to the meeting and asked each member to do self-introduction.

Business of the Day:

The Chairman said that the IDA contracts were supposed to have been supervised by consultants but Department of Feeder Roads carried out an In- House Supervision because procurement process for selection of the consultants have not been completed. Hence the purpose of the meeting was to hand over the supervision of IDA contracts in Central Region for Lots 2, 3, 4, 10 and 13 to M/S Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates.

The team leader of M/S Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates added that they have visited and documented information on the above-mentioned lots of IDA contracts. He gave a brief talk under the following points.

1. World Bank's Requirements

Mr. Joe Lamptey said that Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates had been tasked by the World Bank to submit an inception report on IDA projects in Central Region by the middle of next week. He added that they have gathered information and taken enough pictures for preparation of the report and verification of quality work by technical audit.

He did not hesitate to state that they were concerned with quality of gravel, compaction, concrete works, etc. He was full of praise for DFR for ensuring that work had been done in accordance with specification.

He also expressed concern about safety issues. He said that approval should be sought before using gravel pits and compensation issues should be brought to their attention. He cautioned contractors to ensure that the safety gadgets such as helmets, boots, and gloves are worn on site. He said that there should always be a first aider on site too. Mr. Joe Lamptey said that it was the responsibility of contractors to provide HIV Aids education for workers.

2. Line of Communication

Mr. Joe Lamptey made it clear that all correspondence from contractors should communicate to consultants and consultants will communicate to Director of DFR, Head Office. He did not waver to state that DFR, Cape Coast will be copied in all their communications with the Director of DFR, Head Office.

3. Project Map

Mr. Joe Lamptey distributed project maps to members at the meeting and said that they used the project maps for submission of technical proposal. He pointed out locations of all IDA projects in the region on the map.

4. Progress Report

Mr. Joe Lamptey distributed progress reports prepared by his consulting company. He elaborated on progress of works on all projects. Discrepancies in percentage of physical progress of work reported by M/S Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates and DFR were clarified. Mr. Joe Lamptey entreated contractors to submit program of works as soon as possible in order to facilitate easy monitoring of the projects.

C.K Vasco, a civil engineer of M/S Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates advised contractors not to pile gravel over 200m before spreading since this would generate traffic and can cause accidents. He said that a heavy downpour would make the gravel material wet, hence creating difficulty in spreading them. He added that contractors who need more time for completion of works should write for extension of time as soon as possible.

Mr. Joe Lamptey M/S Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates warned the contractor working on Kwame Alert Jn - Kwame Alert - Amuza road to install a project sign board at the beginning of the project immediately. He said that works on Tayedo – Afonakrom - Dadaguaa road were of good quality, especially concrete works. He added that so many soft spots have developed on the SENCHIEM - AGAVE road. He therefore advised that the SENCHIEM-AGAVE road should be raised by filling. He also pointed out that one of the culverts on SENCHIEM-AGAVE road had not been backfilled.

5. Other Matters

Mr. Emmanuel Okang Klu of Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates said that he had observed a wooden bridge on Kwame Alert Jn - Kwame Alert - Amuza road and asked whether it would be replaced by a culvert. Mr. George Addison, Regional Manager of DFR replied that the wooden bridge would be replaced by a 1800 X 1800mm U culvert.

C.K Vasco of Grid - Goal - Besuma Associates said that consultants will check expiry dates of performance security of contractors. Mr. Joe Lamptey added that validity period of advance mobilization loan of contractors would also be verified. Contract Manager, DFR replied that validity period of advance mobilization loan is “UNTIL FULL RECOVERY”.

6. Closing Remarks

Mr. George Addison, Regional Manager of DFR thanked Mr. Joe Lamptey for the briefing. He assured the consultants and contractors that they should not hesitate to fall on DFR for support. He thanked consultants and contractors for attending the meeting.

The meeting came to a close at 12:56 PM with a prayer by Edward Amegashie.

Recorded by:

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Kwasi Owusu Adu-Gyamfi